

Preparation Checklist

KNOWLEDGE. RIGHTS. ACTION.

Disclaimer: This worksheet is for educational purposes only and is not legal advice. Every case is different. Consult a qualified attorney when possible.

1 KNOW YOUR CASE

- ☐ Case / docket number: _____
- ☐ Court that imposed sentence: _____
- ☐ Offense of conviction: _____
- ☐ Original sentence (length and type): _____
- ☐ Date sentenced: _____
- ☐ Approximate time served to date: _____
- ☐ Attorney of record (if any): _____

2 UNDERSTAND THE PROCESS (RESEARCH)

- ☐ I know what sentence modification is and what it is not
- ☐ I have read about basic eligibility factors
- ☐ I know whether I have filed a prior sentence modification
- ☐ I know whether I have filed an appeal
- ☐ I understand sentence modification vs. habeas corpus
- ☐ I have reviewed Connecticut court process basics
- ☐ I know where my motion would be filed

3 DOCUMENTS TO GATHER

- ☐ Sentencing order / judgment of conviction
- ☐ Information (charging document) or police report summary
- ☐ Prior motions, appeals, or post-conviction filings
- ☐ Program completion certificates
- ☐ Educational transcripts or GED documentation
- ☐ Vocational training records
- ☐ Employment records
- ☐ Treatment or counseling completion records
- ☐ Institutional conduct / disciplinary history
- ☐ Character reference letters
- ☐ Medical documentation (if relevant)
- ☐ Victim-related correspondence (if applicable)
- ☐ Reentry plan draft

4 ORGANIZATION

- ☐ Dedicated folder or binder
- ☐ Documents sorted into labeled sections
- ☐ Written timeline of key events
- ☐ List of what each document proves
- ☐ Legible copies
- ☐ Pages numbered or tabbed

5 BEFORE FILING

- ☐ Drafted a clear personal statement
- ☐ Double checked names, dates, and case numbers
- ☐ Identified required court forms
- ☐ Understand service / mailing requirements
- ☐ Allowed time for review
- ☐ Considered professional legal assistance

NOTES
